Conversation track 1, 3, 4

Vu has a job offer in Melbourne and asks Harriet for advice.

Harriet: So, have you **made a decision** about Melbourne yet?

Vu: Not yet. I keep **having second thoughts**.

Harriet: About the job itself, or the move?

Vu: The move. I don't want to **make a huge mistake**.

Harriet: I get that. But have you **done the maths** on the salary?

Vu: I **did the math** last night. Financially, it **makes sense**.

Harriet: Then it's a no-brainer! Sometimes you've just got to **take the plunge**.

Vu: You would say that. You grew up there.

Harriet: True. So **have a chat** with my brother. He'll show you the ropes.

Vu: That'd help a lot. OK, I'll take it before I change my mind.

Study Notes

Then it's a no-brainer!
Vậy thì còn phải nghĩ gì nữa!
"a no-brainer" là quyết định dễ đến mức không cần suy nghĩ.
Cách nói tương đương: Then it's an easy decision.

He'll show you the ropes.
Anh ấy sẽ chỉ cho bạn đường đi nước bước.
"show someone the ropes" = hướng dẫn người mới cách làm, cách xoay xở ở nơi mới.
Cách nói tương đương: He'll help you get started.

Speak Like a Native track 2

1. Not yet. I keep having second thoughts.
change: "Not_yet" (t + y → ch)
strong: "second thoughts"
"Not yet" nối thành "na-chét". Âm d của "second" gần như mất trước "thoughts": "se-cơn-thots".

2. Sometimes you've just got to take the plunge.
change: "got to" (→ "gotta")
weak: "you've"
strong: "Sometimes", "plunge"
Nói nhanh, "got to" thành "gotta" /ˈgɒrə/, "just" mất t: "jơs". Giọng Úc cũng hay đọc t giữa hai nguyên âm thành d nhẹ.

3. You would say that.
weak: "You"
strong: "would"
Trêu nhẹ: nhấn mạnh "would", đọc đủ /wʊd/ (không rút thành 'd), ý là "bạn thì tất nhiên nói vậy rồi". "say that" hạ giọng.

- Collocation (make a decision, take the plunge) đọc liền như một khối, nhấn vào danh từ.
- Nói nhanh: got to → "gotta", want to → "wanna", going to → "gonna", don't know → "dunno".
- t + y nối thành "ch": not yet → "na-chét", got you → "ga-chu".
- Nhấn trợ động từ để tỏ ý "biết ngay mà": You WOULD say that.

Grammar Focus

make và do

make: tạo ra, đưa ra (a decision, a mistake, sense). do: thực hiện một việc (research, homework, a favor). Anh, Úc nói do the maths; Mỹ nói do the math.

I **made a mistake** on the form.
Could you **do me a favor**?
We **did some research** before buying the car.

take và have

take: chấp nhận, nắm lấy (a risk, a chance, your time, the plunge).
have: trải qua, có (second thoughts, a chat, a go, a look).

Take your time, there's no rush.
She **took a big risk** starting her own business.
Can I **have a go**?

Role Play track 6

A: So, have you made a decision about Melbourne yet?

B: Not yet. I keep _____.

A: About the job itself, or the move?

B: The move. I don't want to _____.

A: I get that. But have you done the maths on the salary?

B: I did the math last night. Financially, it makes sense.

A: Then it's a no-brainer! Sometimes you've just got to take the plunge.

B: You would say that. You grew up there.

A: True. So have a chat with my brother. He'll show you the ropes.

B: That'd help a lot. OK, I'll take it before I _____.

Substitution Drill track 7

1. I keep having second thoughts.
   a. changing my mind
   b. going back and forth
   c. putting it off

2. I don't want to make a huge mistake.
   a. make the wrong call
   b. take that risk
   c. do anything rash

3. OK, I'll take it before I change my mind.
   a. lose my nerve
   b. get cold feet
   c. talk myself out of it